

AGENT RISE / AGENT RISE STUDIO

Medicare Launch Kit

A practical start for licensed Medicare Advantage and Part D agents

Build your ready-to-sell foundation, establish permission-based lead intake, and guide each client from first contact through annual review.

YOUR NEXT STEP

Use this kit to prepare your business, then carry each permitted opportunity into the Agent Rise Client Journey app. The workflow later in this kit shows what to record and when to follow up.

2026 edition • Licensed educational resource

1. How to Use This Kit

This guide is for licensed insurance agents who want a clear path into Medicare Advantage and Part D sales. It organizes the work that sits between holding a license and becoming ready to present plans, enroll eligible beneficiaries, follow up, and retain a book of business.

What This Guide Provides

- A readiness sequence for licensing, annual training, carrier certification, appointment, and local business setup
- A budget-conscious approach to certification and business tools
- Prospecting methods that respect Medicare contact and marketing rules
- A lead-management workflow that can be used manually or inside Agent Rise
- A 30-day plan and final readiness checklist

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Educational and Compliance Notice

This guide provides education and business organization. It does not replace current federal rules, state insurance law, carrier instructions, agency compliance review, or legal advice. Rules, certification prices, carrier requirements, plan availability, and marketing approvals change. Verify each step with the applicable state regulator, carrier, plan sponsor, agency, or FMO before acting.

2.Contents

- 1 Start With a Verified License
- 2 Complete the Ready to Sell Sequence
- 3 Reduce Certification Costs
- 4 Choose an Agency FMO or Upline
- 5 Build the Professional Foundation
- 6 Prospect Within Medicare Contact Rules
- 7 Build a Lead System Beyond Family and Friends
- 8 Rise Above the Competition
- 9 Manage Opportunities With Agent Rise
- 10 Move From Appointment to Annual Review
- 11 Complete the First 30 Days
- 12 Essential Resource Links
- 13 Complete the Final Readiness Check

3.Start With a Verified License

An active license is the starting point. Medicare training and carrier certification do not replace state licensing.

Confirm the Basics

- ☐ Confirm that the resident health insurance license is active and includes the authority required by the home state.
- ☐ Confirm the National Producer Number and the exact name under which carrier contracts will be submitted.
- ☐ Check every nonresident license before marketing or transacting business in another state.
- ☐ Record renewal dates and continuing education requirements.
- ☐ Resolve name, address, or background-question discrepancies before carrier contracting.

License Control Record

Item	Record
Resident state	State and license number
NPN	National Producer Number
Lines of authority	Health and other applicable authority
Renewal date	Calendar reminder set at least 60 days early
Nonresident states	Active status and renewal dates

NIPR provides state-specific licensing information and license-management services. The NAIC directory identifies each state insurance department. Use the regulator's current instructions when state requirements differ.

4.Complete the Ready to Sell Sequence

A license permits insurance activity within its authority. It does not by itself make an agent ready to sell a particular Medicare Advantage or Part D plan.

Step	Milestone	Evidence to Save
1	License verified	Resident and required nonresident licenses are active.
2	Business relationship selected	Agency, FMO, upline, or direct-carrier path is documented.
3	E and O confirmed	Coverage meets the selected organization's and carriers' requirements.
4	Annual Medicare training passed	Complete the current training accepted by the intended carriers.

Step	Milestone	Evidence to Save
5	Carrier certification passed	Complete each carrier's product and compliance modules.
6	Contract and appointment confirmed	Do not assume submission equals approval.
7	Ready to Sell verified	Confirm status for each carrier, plan year, product, and state before presenting or enrolling.

Maintain One Readiness Tracker

Track carrier, writing number, states, products, annual training date, carrier-certification date, appointment status, ready-to-sell status, portal login, and renewal deadline. Save completion certificates and confirmation notices. A memory-based system will eventually miss a renewal or status change.

5.Reduce Certification Costs

The discount matters most before payment. Many savings routes require the agent to enter the training site through a designated carrier or distributor link.

Budget First Process

- ☐ List the carriers and organizations the agent expects to represent.
- ☐ Ask whether they accept AHIP, NABIP, or another approved Medicare training.
- ☐ Ask for the current discount link before registering or paying.
- ☐ Ask whether reimbursement requires production, contracting, or a deadline.
- ☐ Open the special link and confirm the reduced price before completing checkout.
- ☐ Save the receipt and completion certificate.

Current Example

Certification prices and discounts vary by provider and plan year. Ask each intended carrier or distributor for the current accepted training route and discount link before paying. Compare the checkout total and any reimbursement conditions; keep the receipt and completion certificate.

Protect the Exam Attempts

Complete the training modules, use permitted reference materials, and allow enough uninterrupted time for the final assessment. Carrier treatment of failed attempts can differ. Review the intended carriers' rules before using the final available attempt.

6.Choose an Agency FMO or Upline

A higher commission number is not enough. The contract determines access, service, ownership, release terms, and what happens to renewals.

Review Area	Question to Ask in Writing
Contracts	Which carriers and products are available in the target counties and states?
Compensation	What is paid, when is it paid, and what chargeback rules apply?
Ownership	Who owns the book, records, renewals, and client relationship?
Release	How can the agent leave, and how long can a release take?
Vesting	What happens to renewal compensation after termination, retirement, disability, or death?
Leads	Are leads optional? Who owns them? Are co-op terms and chargebacks documented?
Technology	What enrollment, quoting, CRM, call, and compliance systems are required?
Support	Who handles contracting, certification, escalations, and beneficiary service issues?

Do not rely on verbal promises about releases, lead costs, daily pay, renewal ownership, or vesting. Obtain the applicable contract, schedules, and policies, then keep the signed version.

7. Build the Professional Foundation

The agent needs a credible public presence and a private operating system before leads begin arriving.

Minimum Business Setup

- ☐ Professional business email and dedicated phone number
- ☐ Accurate agent name, NPN, license information, and states served
- ☐ Business bank account and simple income and expense tracking
- ☐ Calendar with appointment reminders and protected preparation time
- ☐ Secure storage for contracts, certifications, consent records, and client documents
- ☐ Carrier portal and password inventory stored in an appropriate password manager
- ☐ Simple website with services, service area, contact route, required disclosures, and privacy information

Website Starter

The first website does not need many pages. It needs a clear identity, an accurate service area, a permitted way for visitors to request contact, and a professional next step. Use only approved plan-specific marketing materials and required disclosures. Route every inquiry into the same lead-management process.

Separate Public and Private Work

The public website explains services and invites permitted contact. The private workspace holds lead records, permissions, appointment status, follow-up tasks, and retention dates. Do not publish beneficiary information, Medicare identifiers, health information, or private notes.

8. Prospect Within Medicare Contact Rules

Lead generation begins with a lawful contact path. A name or referral is not automatically permission to call, text, message, or visit.

Permitted Starting Point	Control
Conventional mail and print	May be used for unsolicited outreach, subject to current plan and material rules.
Email	May be used when each message contains an opt-out option and other applicable requirements are met.
Beneficiary initiated contact	Return the inquiry and record the source, date, requested channel, and topic.
Business reply card	Use current approved language and preserve the request record.
Educational event	Provide general Medicare education, communications material, business cards, and a way to request future contact.

Do Not Start Here Without Permission

- Cold calls, robocalls, unsolicited texts, voicemail drops, or social-media direct messages
- Door-to-door solicitation or leaving materials without a previously scheduled appointment
- Approaching beneficiaries in parking lots, hallways, lobbies, or similar common areas
- Calling a referred person unless that person has provided consent or initiated contact

At educational events, do not market specific plans or accept applications. Current federal rules allow business cards, communications materials, beneficiary-initiated questions, Business Reply Cards, and Scope of Appointment forms. Use the current carrier or plan process before advertising or conducting an event.

9. Build a Lead System Beyond Family and Friends

A durable pipeline uses several compliant sources and measures the cost and outcome of each one.

Source	Budget	Primary Value	Measure
Community education	Low to moderate	Trust and permission-based follow-up	Attendance and contact requests
Professional relationships	Low	Introductions and local credibility	Permissioned introductions
Local content	Low	Inbound questions over time	Qualified inquiries
Direct mail	Moderate	Targeted permitted outreach	Response and appointment rate
Approved digital campaigns	Moderate	Inbound form or call	Cost per permissioned lead
Purchased leads	Moderate to high	Faster volume with variable quality	Contact appointment and enrollment rates

Weekly Lead Rhythm

- Run one community or relationship-building activity.
- Publish one useful local Medicare explanation with an approved contact path.
- Follow up only where permission and current rules allow.
- Review stalled opportunities and schedule the correct next action.
- Compare lead sources by appointments and enrollments, not by raw names.

10. Rise Above the Competition

Organization becomes visible to the client as preparation, speed, accuracy, and dependable service.

Choose a Useful Position

Start with a manageable service area and a clear reason for beneficiaries or referral partners to remember the agency. The position may be local availability, patient explanations, benefit-review discipline, service for a defined community, or accessible appointment options. Avoid promises of savings or plan superiority that cannot be supported.

Build Proof Through Service

- ☐ Respond promptly and record the promised next step.
- ☐ Prepare provider, pharmacy, drug, eligibility, and financial questions before the appointment.
- ☐ Explain tradeoffs accurately and document the beneficiary's priorities.
- ☐ Confirm application status and effective date.
- ☐ Schedule an early follow-up and an annual review.

Use a Simple Scoreboard

Measure	Weekly Question
New permissioned leads	How many people asked to be contacted?
Contact rate	How many permissioned leads were reached?
Appointment rate	How many reached leads scheduled?
Enrollment rate	How many completed an appropriate enrollment?

Measure	Weekly Question
Cost per enrollment	Which source produced the result at a sustainable cost?
Follow-up completion	Were promised actions completed on time?

11. Manage Opportunities With Agent Rise Client Journey

Use the Client Journey stages to give each permitted contact a source, permission record, status, and next action. Confirm which app features are available in your account before relying on automated reminders or imports.

Contact Intake

Import or enter the contact without automatically treating the person as an insurance prospect.

Compare duplicate phone numbers and email addresses side by side before keeping, replacing, or merging information.

Record lead source, date received, requested contact channel, permission status, products of interest, state, and county.

Keep non-insurance contacts available as Resource Contacts for appropriate future grouping or export.

The Client Journey Workflow

Stage	Required Control
New lead	Confirm source and permission before outreach.
Qualified	Record location, eligibility context, needs, and intended appointment type.
Appointment scheduled	Set preparation and reminder tasks.
Scope documented	Use the current plan-approved process before the personal marketing appointment.
Needs reviewed	Document priorities without recording unnecessary sensitive data.
Application submitted	Record carrier, confirmation, effective-date expectation, and follow-up.
Enrolled	Complete service follow-up and schedule annual review.

When using a temporary phone-contact import, verify how the app handles removal before making changes. Keep stalled leads in an appropriate follow-up category only where future contact remains lawful.

12. Move From Appointment to Annual Review

The sale is complete only when the application, effective date, client communication, records, and future service date are under control.

Before the Appointment

- ☐ Confirm ready-to-sell status for the product, carrier, state, and plan year.
- ☐ Confirm the lawful contact record and current Scope of Appointment process.
- ☐ Prepare the beneficiary's requested topics and comparison information.

During the Appointment

- ☐ Stay within the documented scope and current plan instructions.
- ☐ Review needs, providers, pharmacies, medications, costs, travel, and service priorities as applicable.
- ☐ Explain limitations and tradeoffs. Do not promise eligibility, savings, acceptance, or benefits that have not been confirmed.

After the Appointment

- ☐ Save confirmation information and required records securely.
- ☐ Track pending items and effective-date expectations.
- ☐ Complete the promised follow-up.
- ☐ Schedule an early service check and annual review.

Retention Through Service

Retention should follow from accurate enrollment, responsive service, and appropriate annual review. It should not be described as guaranteed or made dependent on a billing method. Track the client's chosen communication channel and respect opt-out requests.

13. Complete the First 30 Days

The first month establishes readiness, a professional operating base, and a small measurable lead system.

Period	Primary Work
Days 1 through 5	Verify licenses and NPN; select target states and counties; compare agency, FMO, or carrier paths; confirm E and O requirements.
Days 6 through 10	Secure the accepted annual training route; locate discounts before payment; complete training; preserve certificates.
Days 11 through 15	Complete carrier contracting and certifications; build the readiness tracker; confirm each status rather than assuming approval.
Days 16 through 20	Set up email, phone, calendar, secure storage, website foundation, and Agent Rise contact categories.
Days 21 through 25	Choose three lead sources; prepare compliant materials and permission paths; schedule the first activities.
Days 26 through 30	Run the first outreach cycle; record every source and outcome; review the scoreboard; correct the weakest step.

Day 30 Evidence

- ☐ Ready-to-sell evidence for intended carriers and products
- ☐ One complete business and compliance file
- ☐ Three defined lead sources
- ☐ A working contact and follow-up system
- ☐ A weekly scoreboard with actual results

14. Essential Resource Links

Use official sources for licensing and federal rules. Verify commercial discounts and carrier requirements before payment or submission.

NIPR Licensing Center [Open resource](#)

Apply, renew, manage licenses, and locate state-specific information.

NPN Lookup [Open resource](#)

Confirm the National Producer Number associated with a producer record.

NAIC State Insurance Departments [Open resource](#)

Locate the applicable state insurance regulator.

CMS Medicare Marketing Resources [Open resource](#)

Find current marketing models, standard documents, educational materials, and agent training guidance.

Medicare Advantage Beneficiary Contact Rule [Open resource](#)

Review current federal rules for unsolicited contact, events, personal marketing appointments, and Scope of Appointment.

Medicare Advantage Marketing Requirements [Open resource](#)

Review current general marketing requirements.

AHIP Medicare Training Portal [Open resource](#)

Confirm current training access, plan-year options, and pricing.

Redbird AHIP Discount Information [Open resource](#)

Commercial example. Verify the displayed price and terms before paying.

15. Complete the Final Readiness Check

- ☐ Resident and required nonresident licenses are active.
- ☐ NPN and contracting identity are correct.
- ☐ E and O requirements are satisfied.
- ☐ Annual Medicare training is complete and accepted by the intended carriers.
- ☐ Carrier product certifications are complete.
- ☐ Appointments and ready-to-sell status are confirmed for each intended state and product.
- ☐ Required records, disclosures, permissions, and Scope of Appointment processes are available.
- ☐ Professional email, phone, calendar, website, and secure storage are working.
- ☐ At least three compliant lead sources are defined.
- ☐ Every lead has a source, permission status, category, and next action.
- ☐ Appointment, application, service follow-up, and annual-review stages are defined.
- ☐ The weekly scoreboard is ready.

Sources and Update Check

Review current NIPR, NAIC, CMS, and eCFR guidance before acting. Carrier training, appointment requirements, pricing, and discounts can change during a plan year. Resource links were checked in September 2026.